

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

OPERATION MIDWAY BLITZ

Pritzker signs law in response to crackdown

Bill curbs courthouse
arrests and expands
right to sue agents

By Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

Gov. JB Pritzker on Tuesday signed into law a ban on federal agents making certain arrests near courthouses and easing a path for individuals to sue if they think their rights were violated during civil immigration arrests, capping off months of resistance to the Trump administration's sometimes-violent enforcement crackdown in Chicago and the suburbs.

"We know that this new set of laws can't mitigate all of the harm," Pritzker said at a bill signing ceremony in La Villita Community Church in Little Village, "but it gives us new protective tools and is a symbol of our shared action against those terrorizing our communities and our state."

Lawmakers passed the package of immigration tweaks in October, shortly after President Donald Trump administration's immigration enforcement hit a fever pitch in the Chicago area.

Under the new law, individuals will be better able to sue federal officers for knowingly violating the Illinois or U.S. constitutions during civil immigration enforcement actions. It also codifies a zone around courthouses where people involved in court proceedings are exempt from civil arrest.

The legislation came together in collaboration with House lawmakers, the state attorney general's office and the governor's office, Senate President Don Harmon of Oak Park, who was a key sponsor of the bill, said in October.

While Pritzker and lawmakers

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Madigan the latest Ill. Dem to ask Trump for clemency

Ex-state House Speaker
convicted in February
on corruption counts

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Imprisoned former House Speaker Michael Madigan has become the latest high-profile Illinois Democrat to officially ask President Donald Trump for clemency on a corruption conviction.

Madigan, who was convicted in February on a range of corruption counts, recently filed a clemency petition with the Office of the Pardon Attorney that is still pending as of Tuesday, according to information on the office's website.

The entry says Madigan asked for a "pardon after completion of sentence," but further details were not provided, meaning it's unclear if Madigan has requested to be released from custody early.

The classification of Madigan's request seemed odd on some counts. Typically, defendants still in custody are directed to file a different form seeking a commutation of sentence.

Also, since Madigan is currently not set to be released until he's almost 90 years old, asking for a pardon after he leaves prison would hardly seem worth the effort.

The entry does not say exactly when the request was filed, but it appeared on the pardon attorney's website within the last week. Any specific information or documents submitted on Madigan's behalf as part of the request is not public.

A spokesperson for the Justice

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Chicago police keep watch at the Roosevelt CTA Red and Green Line Station in Chicago on Sept. 23. ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Trump administration threatens CTA funding

Orders city, state to come up with safety plan to boost law enforcement presence

By Alice Yin and Talia Soglin
Chicago Tribune

President Donald Trump's administration has issued a blistering order for the city and state to come up with a safety plan to boost police on the CTA and take other steps or once again risk vital federal funding.

In letters Monday to Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson and Gov. JB Pritzker, Trump's Federal Transit Administrator Marc Molinaro threatened to withhold funds if the CTA does not comply with the demands of a "special directive" issued by the feds by

the start of next week.

The renewed federal order comes after last month's gruesome attack on 26-year-old Bethany MaGee on the CTA's Blue Line in downtown Chicago.

The Trump administration once again invoked MaGee, who was doused with gasoline and lit on fire while riding the train in an apparently random attack, in unveiling its Monday directive.

"It's the responsibility of leaders at every level to create a safe system for all riders and workers on transit," Molinaro wrote. "Chicago's local leaders have neglected that responsibility —

and given Chicago's crime rate in its transit system, this isn't an isolated incident."

It was an apparent reference to Johnson's initial remarks after the attack declining to address whether the suspect should have been out on the streets given his extensive criminal record. The mayor hours later walked back his answer saying the attack against MaGee was an "isolated incident" and said the criminal justice system "failed" her.

Molinaro's statement continued, "If CTA does not take immediate action to increase its law enforcement presence, we will

withhold federal funds." His directive contended the federal government had the authority to freeze up to 25% of its federal grants to the CTA, citing a U.S. law outlining the Urbanized Area Formula Funding program.

The CTA must submit a "security enhancement plan" by Dec. 15 and implement it by Dec. 19, per the FTA's order. That plan must include a commitment to "significantly" increase security or law enforcement on the system, according to the directive.

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INSIDE



E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Obama makes surprise visit

Burke Elementary School student Raniyah Jackson shows former President Barack Obama her coloring of him after he read to kids from the Woodlawn school during a surprise visit to the Bessie Coleman branch of the Chicago Public Library on Tuesday. **Chicagoland**, Page 7

Making history for the Hoosiers

Quarterback Fernando Mendoza is the 2025 Chicago Tribune Silver Football winner — Indiana's first winner in 24 years. **Chicago Sports**



AJ MAST/AP

Some relief after high summer bills

ComEd offers customers \$803 million in energy credits while also seeking a \$268 million reconciliation rate hike. **Business**

Judge grants release of Maxwell files

Ruling cites new law
telling DOJ to open
Epstein documents

By Michael R. Sisak
Associated Press

NEW YORK — A federal judge Tuesday granted the Justice Department's request to publicly release grand jury transcripts and other material from Ghislaine Maxwell's sex trafficking case, citing a new law that requires the government to open its files on Jeffrey Epstein and his longtime confidant, but he cautioned that people shouldn't expect to learn much new information from them.

Judge Paul Engelmayer, who along with other judges who had previously rejected Justice Department unsealing requests before the transparency law was passed, said the materials "do not identify any person other than Epstein and Maxwell as having had sexual contact with a minor."

"They do not discuss or identify any client of Epstein's or Maxwell's," Engelmayer wrote. "They do not reveal any heretofore unknown means or methods of Epstein's or Maxwell's crimes."

The law set a Dec. 19 deadline for the files to be released.

Engelmayer ruled Tuesday after the Justice Department had asked judges in the wake of the law's passage last month to lift

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TODAY'S
WEATHER



High 37

Low 12

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 16

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 344 © Chicago Tribune

